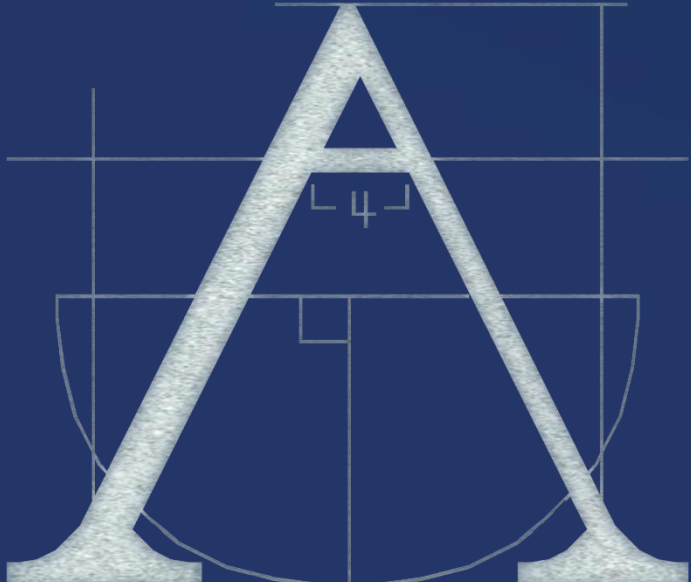


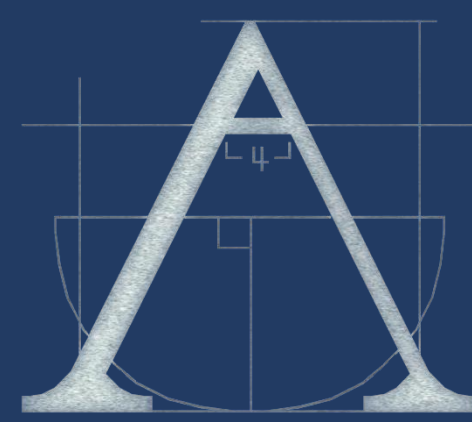


ASTRALGIA



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ASTRALGIA

FOREWORD

Hi! It's me I'm back. Let me start this by saying that the hardest part of making this was choosing the perfect 14 poems to fit. Tough and rough cuts were made with some poems locked inside a vault. I was on a writing spree, to put it, while making this collection. Given that these were written during the summer vacation, I had a lot to write, and the circumstances I had were not that great.

And in classic Renj fashion, when you're down, you right about it. And so here we are, in "Astralgia." Proud to say, I coined the term myself (or maybe there were people before me but I didn't see anything come up when I looked it up). Astra which means "star," and "-algia" a suffix that means pain, the word means pain of stars. Likewise you'll see a glimpse of the intricacies of my mind. I also ordered the poems in a way that it tells a story. The words woven in time, written on paper and shared to you. These are like diary entries that gives you some view of the dance of my thoughts while writing.

So here you have it, Astralgia.

RENJ

AWAY AFTER TEN

I hold scotch on my hand,
As if I could rant to an insomniac.
Two more shots on grand,
As I stare at the alcohol maniac.
I cracked my skull not to be one,
Yet the fumes call otherwise.
I scrunch my nose for it to be gone,
Yet you step close to demise.

I talked my seat,
Then you talked to me again.
In my heart, the fastest beat.
Then you asked where I've been.
I slipped through you hands,
But you wrapped me then.
We run past bands,
And ran away after ten.

On the beach we sat,
Letting the night fallout.
Buckets of stars on our mat,
Above intoxication it's you about.
Thumping beats replaced anger's seat.
Stifled my questions you do.
I stood up and and breathed,
"What about tomorrow?"

THE SKELETONS WILL STEAL STARES

I could be your savior,
One to tuck your demons with.
Hide all the evidence,
Be an accomplices in essence.
Tell me where your demons hide,
I'll tell where are mine.
Look at my eyes and tell me,
The nightmares that haunt you free.
Should my broken bones be needed,
You have all of them mended.
Let's conduct a big arson,
We'll burn all our prisons.

We'll hold funeral to the demons,
We'll bring demise to the omens.
If you drown on your sleep,
I'll pull you up in a sweep.
If you prick your hand on a wheel,
I'll be the dream that makes you heal.
If you cut yourself with your mouth,
I'll be with you in the same route.
You don't have to hide your dreams,
I'll be there for your screams.
Should the star beat faster,
I'll be there to keep your demons under.

No vampire can beat this silver lining,
For you, I'll be faster than lightning.
Our skeletons could meet in the closet,
Because I won't miss the person closest.
They don't get to call what this is,
Our tongues are free from their promise.
They take the road to where time is viscount,
We'll sit where time's a discount.
So don't be afraid of my eyes,
The phantoms will pay their price.
The skeletons will steal stares,
And I get to have what is here.

*ALL
THAT
YOU
NEED.*

When your days are dark,
I'll be the star that lights you up.
When your wars are dark,
I'll be the fire that beams you up.
When your sleep is short,
I'll be the rest you want to stop.
When your patience is short,
I'll be the calm that make you stop.

I am an avoidant of being an option,
In your name I bend directions.
Of all the stars that cover your bed,
If you pick me, I'll give all that you need.

But if you decide that it is chaos,
I'll step back in delight of your choice.
But if you drive from all my chaos,
I'll step back in respect of your choice.
So if you ever ask a little space,
I'll give you the the universe.
So if you demand a larger space,
I'll give up creeping on your universe.

Broken are the days if you won't pick me,
But destroyed is fate if I force it to be.
If you deem my presence to be dim,
Then I'll hide like a long forgotten hymn.

One roar to let this tumult die,
One shout to your sky,
One wish at your prime high,
I'll listen to all of your cries.

If you want my chase to put into rest,
If you want my longings to stay for the best,
I'll peek on the intentions of the dishonest,
And I wish all that you need the farthest.

ONCE OBSOLETE

Back when I was young,
All my pictures were hung.
My smiles all over the walls,
Until in age the man falls.

I used to draw ball gowns,
Now all I do is break down.
The messengers put me high,
Pedestal, second to the sighs.

And they drive away my town,
Their claps became frowns.
A flower that became vine.
They put end to its time.

Back when I was young,
I'm inside of their lungs.
I was the breathe unreviled,
Now they want suicide.

I used to be a life,
Now just someone who's alive.
Torn into pieces,
Deemed unworthy of status.

My pretty lips dried up,
Skin wrinkled, youth stop.
Time is an enemy not to beat.
Will you miss me once obsolete?

ON MY THROAT

I met him once again,
Rubbing my back in my dreams.
His eyes sparkly as it's ever been,
His voice's ecstatic screams.
And my sights locked on him with pain,
As the chills raved the thought of him.

I laid his back towards me,
Catching his breath, counting them.
In an enclosed room it felt free,
We hand control of the ship's helm.
I froze in the fact that this isn't meant to be,
I touch your pricked stem.

In heavy sighs, the bubbles soar,
Rewind to the promises we wrote.
I took one look at your eye like before,
I enclosed you on quotes.
I should've known what these had been for,
But I wake up with your name on my throat.

CLOSE
AN
OPEN
DOOR

I faced my back on the ground,
I'm tired getting into the hound,
And in thought I am found.

I hear your mouth knocking over,
I play dead like do as ever,
And you see my broader lesser.

I used to feel something on my spine,
Back when it was all fine,
Void of the broken lines.

I stare on the walls, all it had been for,
The ghost in me has nothing in store,
You can't close an open door.

I hear your voice calling me out.
If I remember what it had been about,
Then it wouldn't be this South.

I used to feel something when I hear you,
Back when things are true,
Now, I can't bring myself to stand for you.

"You used to speak your truth,
Now, you seem like the youth."
I open my mouth wide open.
I let all words pierce your skin.
"I used to lift you up,
Now I can't even make you stop."
You leave the door wide open.
As I let the loss of you pour in.

HIGH AND UNREAL

This all feels high and unreal,
The ecstasy this makes me feel.
But in the corners I see the devil,
What if we don't get to that level?
Don't take me to nowhere if you're evil.
Store me in your hearts barrel.

If you want to run, then go,
I'll put up a happy show.
The ghosts whispers tricks of you,
Should I believe what you do?
But if you get to escape this show,
Don't evacuate from my heart beating slow.

I dream of you now and then,
All the possible if-then's,
My hands tremble in my nightmare's den,
Slopes pushing me to my roughest skin.
I chose a cyclone to be in,
But please don't run leaving me stranded in.

If the training bears nothing,
Please do not dispose my mumbling.
Headlights' shine might be dimming,
Please do not put me in the middle of scheming.
Wild luck follows us while walking,
If it wake you up, remember my feelings.

If summer puts a pin on our sleepless nights,
Please don't give up without a fight.
If you get scared of all I freight,
Please keep me in your peripheral sight.
And if you have to leave the devil I light,
You have my blessing to do what is right.

I keep dreaming, I'm not the one your kissing,
At least my life, for once, had your blessing.
So while our mind are still in synch,
May we not forget how to sing.
In a timeline of time always chasing,
Don't go dark on this holy blissing.

I LOOKED AT THE SKY

I looked at the sky and wept.
How could be the stars so inept?
I wished for something to happen,
To stop all the bridges from burning.

I caught chances and stored them,
But stolen by time like a lone gem.
I shouted at lightning on thunderstorms,
I'm a sound following the light's arm.

I stared at the stars.
May you disappear all my scars.
In dignity, begging is for the lowmen.
I went on my knees to scrape this omen.

I laid down on the fields I reaped,
And wished the cosmos to take the leap.
They paint themselves the highest grade,
But what about the men in sadness' bathe.

Luck was just a glance,
Swirling fury starts to dance.
I ran to gates of sweet paradise,
But it's reflection of deepest demise.

I looked at the stars,
Why is the good always scarce?
In dignity, begging is away from greatness,
I closed my eyes and dropped my knees.

*THE
SHIMMER
THAT
WRAPS
EACH
RAINDROP*

I used to stare on the rivers at my window
Flowing like my dreams of having another go
I stumble on the cascades of realization
That I could not bare to only have imagination

I look at the shimmer that wraps each raindrop
I remember light from your mouths at night-top
An insatiable desire to be free from the attack
Of my nightly thoughts of coming back

I watch as the waters form a puddle on my front
Similar to the reveries I hide with grunts
The day I awoke from euphoria into woe
I hate the ending but still love the show

I put on cloaks in the misery I encounter
They just fit to right but they feel like others
I try to burn the jigsaw so I would need no piece
But every time I do, curves pull on my peace

I think of the times that it was so right
And wish that I could go back to those nights
I follow my nightmares into daydreams high
And the thought of coming home flies

I crawl back under the bed where it felt real
Where I could still feel all of the surreal
But the darkness starts to catch up on me
And I fly back to the death of you and me

I pry on your business and watch you run your day
And the thought of returning comes to play
Wanting to displace my dismay of the present
I come back to the eve of the day I resent

And I call you and say you come over my dreams
I step forward to free you from my screams
But time ended as the rivulets stopped raining
The Sun has dried this desirous feeling

BLOSSOMING STARLIGHT

Blossoming starlight,
Born to steal the night.
Crowds from left to right,
In your glow they fight.

I'm losing my mind on you,
The time arrived for the new.
My position has to renew,
The arrival of you.

Something has to burn,
Something has to be churned.

Porcelain professionally glazed,
A scent they all chase.
The prize of their race,
You are a no time to waste.

The cynics won and got me,
For more, I am free.
I'm the lucky one to see,
I am the only one of me.

Something has to fade,
Something has to be dread

Your of angelic dusts,
A glimmer that never rusts,
To see you is must,
The jewelries are the past.

I glimmer like a ring,
Pendants to be dazzling.
The air has it red-turning,
Me too have dusts encircling.

Something has to be like time,
Something has been mine.

ARCH BRIDGES

He learned about arch bridges,
A keystone holding all the ridges.
Over a troubled water he crosses,
Vanishing to be devoid of losses.
And so he pulls the keystone,
They won't find him until he's gone.
So he made a cabin inside the woods,
And thought that it felt good.
But the silence was deafening,
So he sought out Hollywood lighting.

He learned about acting,
So he stood on high prime every evening.
His voice piercing silent films,
All the ladies revered him.
But the men were gashing his back,
Pointing on the edges he lacked.
And so he sharpened his wit,
And in turn the candles in his mansion lit.
Prime high may be in concern
For the candles are on their burn.

And so he left to a city no one know him,
A rarity in his life of bright dim.
And so he hid what he was capable,
And tried to live, shook the unstable.
The trains were rigid on the rail,
Like the will to not to fail.
For years he walked like the men in black,
To be one as to please himself back.
He left the days of the embarrassed,
He died alone atop his terrace.

HOW I GOT HERE

I tuck my demons for a walk,
I watch as the birds talked,
I watch the clouds as they tell the Sun to rise,
And so I forget being the consolation price.

I watch the leaves fall,
I look at the purple petals,
I watch as the pale blue get frozen in time,
And so I forget my soul not being mine.

I look at the air come and go,
I witness how the winds flow,
I see the seas roughing up the oceans,
And so I forget being afraid of my own man.

I witness as the Sun sleeps,
I wonder how the moon creeps,
I marvel on the craters born by admiration,
And so I forget my moonless valleys of illusions.

I wonder on the stars,
I gaze on the connections at far,
I stand in awe to the constellations that formed,
And so I forget being the stitched yet deformed.

I gaze on the firefly haze,
I observe how they pull a maze,
I stand in astonishment to the paths they grew,
And so I forget my mind filled of awry blue.

I love it here, where I am not.
A place they don't know where.
They reek on what they got,
Because they don't know how I got here.

They tended away of my potential,
So they got rid of all the garden seeds.
These dreamscapes come unintentional
To a boy no one reads.

DOWN TOWN IDENTITY STORY

I was so high and never felt so low,
Wandering eyes wherever I go,
Tricked by lights in a constant show,
Be everything but never slow.

The thorns grew out of the trophies,
From success brewed anomalies,
An empire down to the ground is seized,
A city looked up to please.

And so burn my castled down,
Like how I've burned for you, my town.
You creeped onto the village of my identity,
And trashed interest later in the story.
The crowds shouted my name,
Until the sun sat on fame.
Power was what you gave me,
But power killed the dreamer in me.

I was on my way to build stories,
But you overshadow deranged memories,
And you will kill me for saying all these,
I can't lash out to the people I please.

You drowned me in my own tears,
Pressed me low for two years,
Call hallucination to my ears,
And pictured versions of me as your fears.

And the harbor is down,
I permanently closed my town.
Away from the eyes devoid of identity,
The ones who crafted me a story.
You gave me tears, gave me my name,
You put me in the dirtiest fame.
You poked the beast sleeping in me,
And ran when you saw the truth in me.

THE TIMELINE CREASE

And in the cessation of his story,
He tried to glorify his memory.
The talismans were a stroke short,
The ones hostile to restort.
Deflation from the breath within,
Sighs from where he had been.
Sky is a graveyard of stars.
An uninhabitable valley of scars.

The wars ravished his temples,
His castles came to crumble.
The bruises came to a truce,
If he choose, he gets to lose.
The world is just a line,
Illusions that you're not benign.
Locked by the illusion of choice,
The dark is at poise.

An illusion never gone,
Zero is the only thing less than one.
Airless lungs growing grudge,
In my veins, the fury takes lodge.
The mass of their voices ,
Are pressed into no choices.
Dense as the cases up their sleeves,
Elusive like the leaves.

The ugliness is the most attractive,
The accusatives bceome the nominative.
Habitability relies in their hostility,
Existence lives in their memory.
The volatiles creep on the innocents,
Villains acting victims of their torments.
To cry is a joke in nature,
To take rebuttal is immature.

They fall on their knees
As they fold the timeline crease.
Constellations behold of stupidity.
The notorious hide in anonmity.
So stars, take them out,
Crush what all of this is about.
A dream's creator shall die
To live in the world of awry.







R E N J



AWAY AFTER TEN
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